A noiseless and quiet atmosphere is a must for an office to maintain the efficiency of the employees at high level. Noise may be internal and external. Noise can be controlled through following measures:

- Separating noise making machines from the main office.
- Fitting doors with door closers and rubber lining.
- Housing the telephone switchboard away from the general office.
- Using sound absorbing material on floors, walls and ceilings.
- Covering floors with rubber, coir or plastic mats, etc.

3.5.3. Cleanliness:

A clean and tidy office is important as it offers the following advantages:

(i) It is healthier as a work place for different types of office workers.

(ii) Since people react to their surroundings, a clean and healthy office contributes to accuracy and efficiency

(iii) A clean and tidy office also projects a good image of the organization in the eyes of the people who visit it.

Disposal of Waste: Proper disposal of waste and waste paper is very essential.

Toilets: Proper provision of toilets and their proper cleanliness are important. Toilets should be conveniently located with adequate number. It must be properly stocked with soap, toilet paper and towels. Paper napkins or towels are convenient and hygienic.

The cleaning work should be undertaken either before or after the business hours in the office. In addition to the daily cleaning, a definite programme of special cleaning should be laid down and followed. This sort of special cleaning should be a comprehensive one and no part of the office should be left uncleaned.

3.5.4. Safety Measures:

One of the vital functions of a modern office is to keep and preserve documents and records for future guidance or reference. All documents or records of office should therefore be kept under proper security. The following precautions should be taken to secure documents and employees:

(i) **Fire Precautions:** Adequate fire precautions should be taken for the preservation of office records and documents, machines against risk of loss or destruction by fire. Similarly precautionary measures to safeguard the employees in the office should also be provided in the office. Adequate fire extinguishing equipment should be installed and the staff should be trained in its use. Fire alarms should be fixed in conspicuous places. Such appliances should be regularly inspected to ensure that they are in working order.

(ii) **Accident Prevention:** Most accidents occur due to overcrowding in the office; use of obsolete machines and

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